**QP Code: 25900441**

**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**
**MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025**
**Third SEMESTER**
**Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG3VACHIS200 - IDEA OF INDIA**
**(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)**

## Part A

SHORT ANSWER
Answer any **5** questions
Each question carries **2** marks

1) Stress on personal devotion- love of God- social inclusivity- criticism on ritual formalism- cut across caste and religious boundaries. Evidence of syncretism- mutual respect- and the fostering of harmonious inter-community relations.
2) Sacred maps- religious sites, pilgrimage routes, and zones of cultural importance- Diana Eck- Sacred map as analytical tools of cultural and religious influence over time. Helps in identifying - patterns of religious diffusion, expansion of cultic centres, and the symbolic assertion of territory.
3) Dharma in ancient India- 2 types - Dharma as justice, welfare and moral code of conduct - Dharma as preservation of Varna-Ashrama Dharma- Students can either go with the first or the second one.
4) Iconic symbol of maternal sacrifice- feminine embodiment of Bharat- evokes emotional unity across regions- drawn from Bankim Chandra's Vande Mataram- 1905 Swadeshi Movement context- promotes anti-colonial devotion- blends Hindu iconography with secular nationalism- critiqued for potential exclusion of non-Hindu identities.
5) Political democracy requires a base of social democracy-Caste oppression undermines citizenship- hierarchy v/s social equality- social equality via annihilation of caste-constitutional and legal remedies to secure equal citizenship-reservations as tools for inclusion-casteless republic for true unity
6) Strong central government v/s significant powers to the states- preserving national cohesion v/s recognising linguistic and cultural diversity-Quasi-federal structure-flexible boundaries-balanced diversity with indivisibility- concurrent list for shared sovereignty.
7) Nehru and equal respect for all faiths and state neutrality-state as neutral arbiter with reform powers-western secularism and strict separation of church and state.
8) The student can write about dowry, early marriages, restriction in education and employment or any such oppressing practices. The student should briefly mention the consequence of such practice.

## Part B

SHORT ESSAY
Answer any **4** questions
Each question carries **5** marks

9) Gandhi’s idea of Harijan upliftment via moral persuasion rather than institutional reform- Poona Pact and compromise with Ambedkar- conservative- varna system as

division of labour- paternalistic retention of hierarchy- ignored structural violence- limited radical change—post-independence persistence of caste.

10) Immediate curtailment of civil liberties- fundamental rights- press- MISA- democratic erosion. programmes with coercive elements- sterilisation- slum clearance. political consequences- 1977 debacle- 42nd and 44th amendments. long term impacts- weakening of public trust, federal assertion.
11) Articles 25-30- balance between accommodating religious diversity and safeguarding public order. Shirur Mutt case of 1954-balances liberty with secular regulation- ensures pluralism amid diversity.
12) Vernacular literature- Songs, street theatre, folk performance, print media, cinema and festivals- embedded nationalist symbols in popular imagination- bridged urban/rural divides- mobilised subalterns- fostered emotional bonds- nationalism through regional motifs- examples such as swadeshi boycotts via art- role in reinforcing unity.
13) Bhagat Singh and secularism and atheism- Why I Am an Atheist (1930)- revolution as class struggle against imperialism- HSRA bombings as praxis- India as exploited proletariat. Subhash Chandra Bose and anti-imperialist tactics- Forward Bloc (1939)- socialist planning- INA's socialist welfare- anti-fascist alliances- both globalised swaraj- armed resistance over non-violence- envisioned egalitarian post-colonial state- state led industrialisation- fused socialism with nationalism.
14) Influence on peasant and labour movements- agrarian equality- labour rights- land reforms- welfare policies- Telangana peasant uprising (1946)—Kerala land reforms (1957, EMS)—caste-class linkages. Failure to bring into perspective class, caste, religion and fragmented rural economy- internal splits- CPI and CPI(M)- turn to parliamentary politics- disconnect with urban middle class- neglect of identity politics- Naxalism, violence and isolation.
15) Vedic era- women debaters 27 women contributors—agency in Rigveda hymns- 'notion of golden age for women'- Yajnavalkya Gargi Debate and threat of violence- only 15 hymns of 1028 were composed by women- was it a golden age? Buddhism/ Jainism- early unwillingness to accommodate nuns- Post Maurya period and composition of Smritis of Manu and Yajnavalkya- cementing of patriarchal dominance- women rebels- bhakti movement- challenge to patriarchy during caste and religious reform movements.

## Part C

ESSAY QUESTION

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

16) Dual task of National movement- pan- India unity and accommodation of variations- INC's federal vision- 1920 Nagpur Session- accommodated sub-nationalisms via composite nationalism- multi regional leadership within INC- provincial organisations- All India States Peoples Conference. Mechanisms of reconciliation- linguistic provinces movements- States Reorganisation Act- Quasi federal Constitution. Failures: Mistrust and fear of dominance- Dravidian movement- insurgency- constitution leading more towards a union- strong centre and destructible states- emergency powers and financial powers.
17) What is experimental practice? - systematic trial- improvement- technical knowledge- visibility in material culture or as literary evidence. Evidence- medicine: Charaka and

Sushruta Samhita- practical training and surgery. Metallurgy- coins (transformation from punch marked to dye cast), statues (lost wax technique from Indus valley period)- pillar (especially Chandra pillar- rust resistant composition) and weapons- wootz steel (Crucible process- south India). Dyeing- murals and textiles. How historians can identity the practices- cross-referencing literary descriptions with archaeological finds- experimental archaeology- scientific techniques- Value liberally

18) Constitutional background of the question- Article 30 and fostering pluralism via autonomy- protection against majoritarianism. minority institution- role in preserving community identity and social integration- modern education to excluded groups- space for intercultural contact-possibility of dialogue- cultural preservation. Risk of parochialism- minority autonomy v/s public accountability- debates on insularity.
19) Gandhi- Rama Rajya- Nation as moral community rooted in spiritual values- self-sacrifice- swaraj as soul-force- self-reliance- moral regeneration- religious symbolism and political mobilisation. Tagore- nationalism as a narrow ideology- individual dignity- cosmopolitan humanism- artistic freedom- fear of nationalism as a divisive and violent force. Gandhi v/s Tagore- Mass mobilisation v/s fear of exclusivist tendencies/ parochialism.